Build plan from here

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Fix Chotu first, then turn on real accounts and metrics, then give pods company and goals, and only then take money. Everything below was checked against the code in your app folder on 18 Oct.

Order of work

Each step unlocks the next, so they run in this order. Steps 2 and 3 can run side by side.

1. **Fix Chotu.** Already running in its own thread. Nothing else matters if the first conversation is garbled, and the roadmap builder and pod friends both run on Chotu.
2. **Accounts complete.** Email and password sign-up, verification, password reset, then switch sign-in on for everyone. Without this nobody can pay and access can't be switched off.
3. **Metrics in place.** Installs by channel, feedback, and day 1/7/30 return rates, before the first outside user arrives, so the pod test produces numbers.
4. **Pod friends.** Chotu's labelled AI friends keep a new pod alive until real members fill it.
5. **Roadmap builder.** The free roadmap is the hook; the weekly plan that rebuilds itself is the first Plus feature.
6. **Payments live.** One product, sold on the web first, once the legal pages and the gateway's checks are done.
7. **Pod test with about 100 aspirants plus a founding-member pre-sale.** This is what settles the business model with real numbers.

Accounts and login

About two thirds is built; the gaps are email and password, password reset, and switching it on.

Piece	State today	Where
Sign-in with Google and phone OTP	Built on web and Android	`server/src/auth.ts`, `public/app/auth.js`, `android/.../SignIn.kt`

Piece	State today	Where
Accounts table, suspend and restore from admin, erase with tombstone	Built	`migrations/0001_accounts.sql`, admin console
Switch to force sign-in (`sign_in_required` flag)	Built, off	admin flags
Firebase project connected	Not done: `FIREBASE_PROJECT_ID` is empty, so the live server refuses every sign-in	`wrangler.jsonc`
Email and password sign-up	Not built	
Email verification and password reset emails	Not built	
Account page: change email, sign out everywhere, delete account	Partly (delete exists)	

Plan. Add Firebase's email and password provider next to Google. Firebase sends the verification and reset emails itself, free, from a template we brand with the app name and your domain. Keep phone OTP as an option but not the default, because each SMS costs money and Firebase caps free SMS. Then turn on `sign_in_required`, so an unpaid or banned install loses access even if the app stays on the phone.

Payments

Start with a one-time yearly payment through Cashfree on the website, not a monthly subscription and not inside the Android app.

What exists. `server/src/plus.ts` already has the Plus limits, prices (₹299 a month, ₹2,499 a year, 7-day trial), entitlements and the rule that offers only show in Prep. It runs in test mode only: there is no payment gateway code anywhere in the app, and I found no trace of Cashfree in the app folder, the project files or the artha folder (which is empty). Whether your old Cashfree account is still active can only be checked in its dashboard.

Why this order is easiest.

- **One-time over monthly.** Recurring card and UPI debits fall under RBI's e-mandate rules (customer approval, pre-debit notices, limits). A one-time yearly payment needs none of that.
- **Web over in-app.** Inside a Play Store app, Google requires its own billing (or its user-choice billing, which still takes a fee) for digital purchases. Paying on the website avoids that while the pod test runs on a direct APK. Play Billing comes later, when the app goes on the Play Store.
- **Cashfree over Razorpay.** Both fit; Cashfree wins only if your old account and its KYC still work, which saves the onboarding.

What the gateway will check before it goes live. Business PAN and bank account, and a live website with privacy policy, terms, a refund policy, a contact page and prices shown. GST on online coaching is 18%; ask your CA when you must register.

Build. Cashfree checkout on the web app, a webhook that marks the account as Plus, a receipts page, and refunds from the admin console. The app reads the entitlement from the server, so a web purchase unlocks the phone too.

Marketing metrics

The admin console counts daily totals today (`daily_counts` in `admin.ts`), but it can't tell where an install came from or whether a person came back.

Metric	How we get it	State
Installs and uninstalls	Play Console once listed; for the APK and web, a first-open event	Not built
Install source (Instagram, Telegram, a friend's invite)	Tagged links plus Google's install referrer on Android, invite codes for pod invites	Not built
Sign-ups and activation (finished onboarding, joined a pod, first Chotu chat)	Server events per account	Not built
Return rate on day 1, 7 and 30, by sign-up week	Server events per account, shown in admin	Not built
Engagement: pod messages, rituals done, Chai cards read, Chotu turns, Prep minutes	Server counts, some already in `daily_counts`	Partly

Metric	How we get it	State
Feedback	Chotu's Report button exists; add a one-tap rating after key moments and a 2-question check-in on day 7	Partly
Paid funnel: offer shown, checkout started, paid, refunded	Events from `plus.ts` and the payment webhook	Not built

I'd keep this on our own server rather than adding a third-party tracker, since we already promise that mood, journal and chat stay private. The admin console gets one Growth page with these numbers and the pod-test thresholds from your brief (week-4 activity under 30% means stop, over 50% means strong).

Roadmap builder

The free roadmap shows the whole road; Plus turns it into a weekly plan that adjusts to what the student actually did.

Inputs, asked in Chotu's Plan tab (already on screen, mostly empty). Target exam year, attempt number, optional subject, hours a day, working or full-time, weakest papers, and the profile we already collect in stages.

Free. A one-page roadmap from today to Prelims and Mains: phases (foundation, revision, tests), subjects in order, hours per week, and three milestone checks. Built from rules plus a syllabus map, with Chotu explaining it in the student's words. It can be shared as an image, which also helps marketing.

Plus (the upsell). The weekly plan: specific topics and Prep items each day, rebuilt every Monday from what got done, missed days absorbed without guilt, and mock bands feeding back into it. The offer appears at the moments already defined in `plus.ts` (for example after four weeks of rhythm), and only in Prep.

Depends on. Chotu fixed, the syllabus map (starting with GS2 Polity), and the nudge and trigger design in the AI platform thread, which this plan's reminders should use.

Pod friends

Give Chotu three or four named AI friends who live in pods, each always labelled AI, and step them back as real members arrive.

What exists. Chotu already hosts pods (`server/src/pod.ts`): at most 2 posts a day, never between 23:30 and 07:00, answers @Chotu, sets a weekly goal and runs a quiz. That's why a new pod feels quiet.

The change. A small cast with distinct roles, for example a repeater who shares what went wrong last time, a working professional who studies at 6 am, a Hindi-medium student strong in GS1, and a quizzer. Each has its own kulhad colour and name tag ending in "AI". They post a few times a day, start answer-writing hours and quizzes, react to wins, and talk to each other so the pod has a pulse.

Rules that keep it honest.

- Every message says AI, and they are never counted as members or in pod numbers.
- They never DM anyone, never pretend to have a rank or result, and never comment on one member's mood or progress in public.
- They go quieter as the pod fills: full activity with 0 to 2 real members, light with 3 to 5, only on rituals after that.
- This changes the 11 Oct rule "no fake members" to "no undisclosed AI members", which matches your note that it's obviously AI.

Business model

In one line: the community is free forever and brings people in; Prep Plus is the one thing we sell, to the few percent who get serious.

Layer	What's in it	Price	When
Adda (free, never sells)	Pods and AI friends, Chai news, Commons rooms, Close the Day, Calm, on-device Chotu	Free	Now
Prep free	Practice, 1 mock a month with a band, 3 answer feedbacks a week, the free roadmap, 15 cloud Chotu turns a day	Free	Now
Prep Plus	Weekly plan that rebuilds itself, unlimited feedback and mocks with breakdowns, 100 cloud Chotu turns a day	₹2,499 a year (₹299 a month later)	At the pod test
Founding member	Plus for the first year, a badge, a say in what gets built	Suggest ₹999 for the first 300	Pre-sale during the pod test
Sprints and mentors	100-day Prelims or Mains sprint with a weekly human touchpoint; 1:1 mentors	₹2,999 to ₹5,999; mentors later	After Plus proves itself

Why this shape. SuperKalam sits at about ₹399 a month or ₹2,999 a year, so ₹2,499 is just under it while the community is the difference. One product keeps the pre-sale test clean: if fewer than 5 of 30 offered seats sell, the price or the product is wrong.

The maths to watch. 50,000 active members × 3% paying × ₹2,499 is about ₹37 lakh a year. I'd set a target of under ₹200 a year in cloud AI cost per Plus user, which the AI platform thread's stack and `ai-economics.xlsx` should confirm.

What only you can do

- [ ] Check the Cashfree dashboard: is the account active and is KYC complete? If not, say whether to use Razorpay instead.
- [ ] Create a Firebase project (or share the existing one's project id) and turn on Email/Password and Google sign-in.
- [ ] Decide the business entity and talk to your CA about GST.
- [ ] Approve the business model above, especially the founding price and the change from "no fake members" to "no undisclosed AI members".
- [ ] Pick a domain for the website and the sign-in emails.
- [ ] Rebuild and install the APK when the Chotu fix lands.